

10 Month Plan

Farron Blanc |
March 2026

helm

Working Session

Team

First 5 Hires

- Co-founder CPO (month 1)
- Full stack Staff Engineer (month 2)
 - Builder not manager, BaaS API KYC experience
 - Deary Hudson (or network)
- Contract Front-end & DevOps (month 2-3)
 - Make Sept launch
 - Front-end (reg flow), DevSecOps
- Fractional CCO (month 4-5)
 - Disclosures, Design partners reviews
 - Stacy Koran (First Consulting)

Open Thoughts

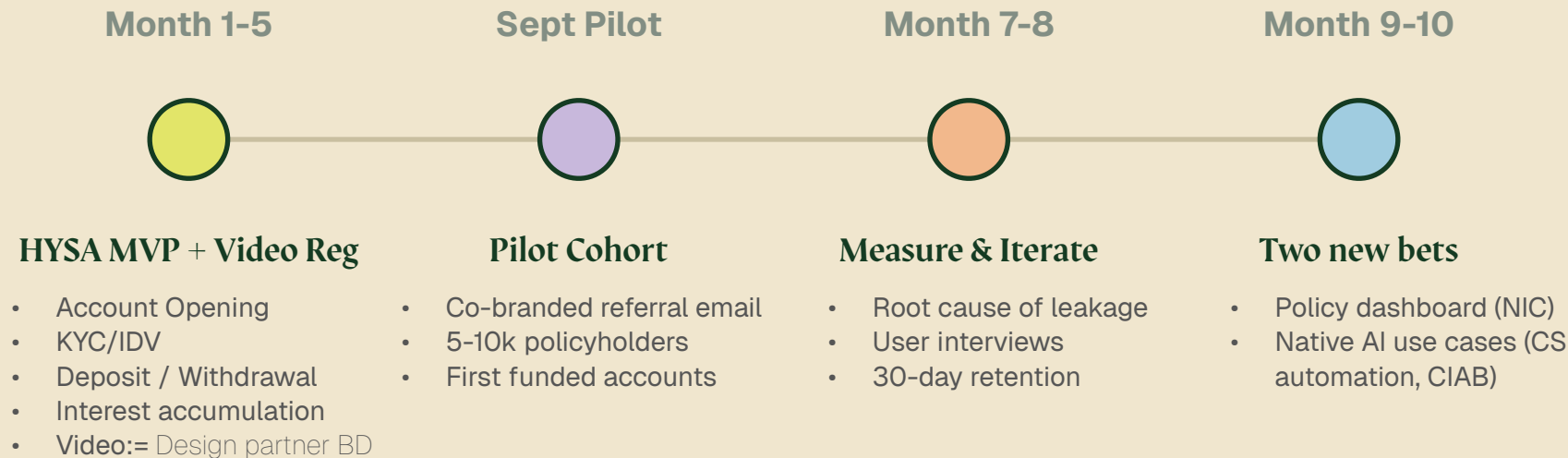
Will need to rely on Runyon + EJF + Optimist to open aperture

I run down every referral. Source via; wellfound, underdog, slack referrals

VPEng/CTO defer until pre-Series A unless phenomenal comes along

Gerry the mission resonated well with candidates, Helm will be more nuanced

Product

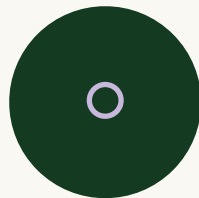


Go To Market



Banner Life

Second OKR = getting signed -
BUT default assumption is that
they stall out/flake out



NM or others

Advance NML
Fast follow (parallel) SBLI / MoO



IMO Distribution

Long term defensibility + drive
carriers

Warrants = evangelists
Crump (\$400M), LIBRA (\$500M),
Accuquote (\$80M)



Risks

Risk	Detail	Mitigation
Co-Founder & CPO Hire	- Helm needs to be world class in consumer fintech & B2B2C onboarding. - Need THE best otherwise I'm wrong person for seat.	Fly to SF spend 2 days "Overpay" to secure
Banner stalls and/or walks away	My base case assumption due to; - Cobalt distraction - Champion whose capital is finite - Compliance & ARB sign-off takes months	HYSA doesn't depend on Banner. Build regardless. Pivot to a new set of policyholders. Don't need carrier's permission if go through original distributor
Seed co-lead	Target June Closing with additional \$1.5M	List of 65 VCs
BaaS partner delays	Assuming 3 month MVP vs 6 month build	Parallel path two BaaS
Compounding assumptions	Strong Series A (\$10-20M) is predicated on user conversion, growth, deposits, retention	Need pilot conversion stats





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lifeatthehelm.com

farron.blanc@gmail.com

